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Course: 21LEM202T - Universal Human Values - II

Unit – 3 : Session – 3 | Respect — Right Evaluation

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

1. Q1. RESPECT (sammaan) is RIGHT EVALUATION — evaluating the other as they truly are: as a human being who is a co-existence of Self and Body, same as me at the level of Self. When I evaluate rightly, the feeling of respect naturally follows. Disrespect is the result of WRONG evaluation — evaluating on the basis of body, wealth, post, age, gender or beliefs rather than on the basis of the Self.
2. Q2. The THREE wrong evaluations are: (1) OVER-EVALUATION — evaluating for MORE than what is there (flattery, hero-worship: 'he can do no wrong'); (2) UNDER-EVALUATION — evaluating for LESS than what is there (looking down, dismissing: 'he is useless'); (3) OTHERWISE-EVALUATION — evaluating something that is NOT there (suspicion, false accusation). All three are forms of disrespect because none sees the other as they are; respect is only the exact, right evaluation.
3. Q3. The MINIMUM content of respect is the recognition of SIMILARITY: the other is a human being like me — the Self is the same in both (same activities of desire, thought, expectation; same natural acceptance; same program of happiness). On this minimum basis, every human being — regardless of age, status, gender or nationality — deserves respect. This is non-negotiable and universal.
4. Q4. The COMPLETE content of respect is the recognition of COMPLEMENTARITY: though the Self is the same, our COMPETENCE differs — if the other has more understanding, I accept them as a source of guidance; if I have more understanding, I accept the responsibility of guiding them. So full respect = similarity at the level of Self + complementarity at the level of competence. This makes relationship purposeful, not merely polite.
5. Q5. RESPECT is based on right evaluation of the human being as a whole (similarity + complementarity), while DIFFERENTIATION is discrimination on partial, bodily or accidental grounds — rich/poor, high/low caste, male/female, ours/theirs, powerful/weak. Differentiation always produces disrespect somewhere (someone is under-evaluated) and hence conflict. Today's movements for equality and dignity are essentially protests against differentiation and demands for respect based on the common Self of all human beings.